Asthma Pathophysiology, Spirometry & GINA Stepwise Therapy

Detailed lecture notes covering bronchial hyperresponsiveness, spirometric FEV1/FVC reversibility criteria, inhaler therapy, and acute exacerbation management.

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1. Pathophysiology of Bronchial Asthma

Asthma is a chronic inflammatory disorder of the conducting airways characterized by bronchial hyperresponsiveness, reversible airflow obstruction, eosinophilic infiltration, and goblet cell hyperplasia resulting in mucous plugging.

2. Spirometry & Reversibility Testing

Diagnostic confirmation requires demonstrating airflow limitation (reduced FEV1/FVC ratio < 0.70) with significant bronchodilator reversibility: an increase in FEV1 by >= 12% and >= 200 mL measured 15 minutes post albuterol inhalation.